



Laser Treatment for Glaucoma: Selective Laser Trabeculoplasty (SLT)

What is SLT?

Selective Laser Trabeculoplasty (SLT) is a laser treatment used to lower eye pressure in people with open-angle glaucoma or high eye pressure (ocular hypertension).

It helps fluid drain more easily from the eye, which can help protect your vision.

Why is SLT done?

SLT may be recommended if:

- Eye drops are not working well enough
- You're having side effects from your drops
- You want to reduce or stop using drops
- You're newly diagnosed and want a non-medication option

How does it work?

- A special laser gently treats the drainage area inside your eye (called the trabecular meshwork)
- This helps the eye fluid drain better, lowering the pressure
- The laser does not damage the eye

What happens during the procedure?

- Takes about 5–10 minutes
- Done in the clinic
- Your eye is numbed with drops
- A lens is placed on your eye to help the laser reach the drainage angle
- You may see bright lights or feel light pressure, but it's not painful
- Your eye pressure will be checked after

After the procedure

- You may have mild irritation or blurry vision for a few hours
- Anti-inflammatory drops may be prescribed
- You can usually return to normal activities the same day
- Follow-up visits are needed to check your eye pressure



How well does SLT work?

- SLT lowers pressure in about 70–80% of patients
- Pressure may take up to 6 weeks to drop
- Some people can reduce or stop using eye drops
- SLT can be repeated if needed

Risks and Side Effects

SLT is very safe.

Possible side effects:

- Mild discomfort or redness
- Temporary pressure spike (your doctor will monitor this)
- Very rarely, blurry vision or inflammation

When to call your eye doctor

Contact your clinic if you have:

- Eye pain that gets worse
- Vision that gets worse
- Nausea or vomiting (can be a sign of high pressure)